

Successful Partnership Between STERNAUTO and Ribbex GmbH

A Partnership that Redefines Efficiency, Security, and Sustainability

ABOUT STERNAUTO

STERNAUTO is a leading German chain of vehicle dealerships, offering a wide range of brands including Mercedes-Benz, smart, BYD, INEOS Grenadier, and FUSO. With around 1,600 employees across 25 branches in six states—Berlin, Brandenburg, Mecklenburg–Western Pomerania, Saxony, Saxony-Anhalt, and Thuringia—the company prides itself on high-quality standards and continuous development. As part of the Lei Shing Hong Group, it benefits from international expertise and outstanding service.

Industry

Automotive / Transportation

Country

Germany

The Challenge

In 2021, STERNAUTO's IT department decided to modernize its aging printer fleet. 50 devices were no longer usable, and spare parts were becoming difficult to source. The team set out to find a solution that would make printer maintenance efficient while ensuring operational stability.

Solution at a glance

- **HP Services:** Managed Print Services (MPS)
- **HP Software:** HP Security Manager, Web Jetadmin, Find Me Print
- **HP Hardware:** LaserJet and Color LaserJet Enterprise MFP printers

Leading vehicle dealership chain STERNAUTO is committed to innovation and quality in every aspect of its operations. When it came time to modernize its printing infrastructure, the company was looking for a reliable partner that could meet its high efficiency and security standards. Comprehensive printing solution specialist and experienced HP partner **Ribbex GmbH** proved to be the perfect match.

"Our staff can focus more heavily on our customers and the STERNAUTO IT team can spend more time on higher-value topics and projects that enable us to drive our business forward."

— Lars Dathe, Service and Provider Management Team Leader, STERNAUTO

Ribbex GmbH's Solution: Greater Efficiency and Security

STERNAUTO and Ribbex GmbH began their successful working relationship in 2021. The two companies agreed on a comprehensive service contract covering maintenance, repairs, and toner supplies, as well as a consolidation of the printer fleet. Ribbex deployed its own technicians to manage consulting, installation, and on-site support.

"We want to have the option for maintenance to be performed on the printers remotely," explains Lars Dathe. "Remote access and remote control are therefore incredibly important to us, as is having a partner that can access our infrastructure to check and configure it off site. Critical departments such as accounting and HR are heavily reliant on print services. These are key business processes that we can't afford to lose, even temporarily."

Key Business Benefits Delivered

- **Efficient print processes:** Modern laser technology accelerates printing and scanning across 25 dealership sites.
- **Increased security:** Functionalities such as 'Find Me Print' protect confidential records from unauthorized access and

Partner Profile

With over 40 years' experience, Ribbex GmbH has evolved from a wholesaler into a full-service provider for printers, copiers, and managed print services, offering customized solutions for medium-sized businesses and public authorities.

facilitate secure mobile badge authentication.

- **Fleet Optimization:** Ribbex GmbH enabled STERNAUTO to consolidate its printer fleet down from 530 to 490 devices, with a roadmap to a streamlined, homogenous fleet of 300 printers by the end of 2025.
- **Waste & Cost Reduction:** Jobs that are no longer needed can be deleted prior to release, significantly decreasing expenditure on paper, toner, and power.
- **Reduced IT workload:** Centralized firmware administration and HP Security Manager automate certificate and policy management.

The Future: Digitalization 2.0 and AI-Ready Infrastructure

"Digitalization 2.0 is looming on the horizon; we have to start working with artificial intelligence (AI) to optimize our processes. The time savings we achieve with the solution are more valuable than ever before," explains Dathe. STERNAUTO is not only incorporating state-of-the-art technologies, but also utilizing strong partnerships to help prepare for future challenges.

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